

2.5 Unit 2, Option C: Conflict and Change in 19th and 20th Century Britain

Focus

Grounded in an understanding of the relevant chronology, this option concentrates on key developments in social and political change in Britain in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, with particular emphasis on an understanding in some depth of the impact of war on public attitudes, medicine, social change and the factors influencing women's changing role and opportunities in a mature industrial society. It gives students the opportunity to understand how developments in one area (eg the pressures of fighting wars or providing opportunities for female education) can have significant impact in others (eg in medicine and surgery or political activism).

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in Appendix 1.

Students entered for Option C are required to study ONE topic: C1 or C2.

C1 The Experience of Warfare in Britain: Crimea, Boer and the First World War, 1854-1929

- The impact of the Crimean War: significance of newspaper reporting; medical and nursing developments; pressure for army reforms.
- The impact of the Second Boer War: propaganda; support for, and questioning of, Britain's imperial role; national efficiency campaigns; impact on social reform.
- The experience of war on the Western Front: outline of Britain's involvement; medical and surgical developments; creation, recruitment and retention of a mass army; morale and discipline of troops; effectiveness of strategy and tactics.
- The impact of the First World War on the home front; changing attitudes to the conflict; work and working practices; propaganda; organisation of the state for total war.